



Raccoon Diplomacy

A peer-led harm reduction group. We den together.

We're a harm reduction group. That means we help people who use drugs stay alive and be safer — **without asking them to stop first.**

We're peers. Not clinicians, not counsellors, not anybody's licensing board. Lived experience counts as knowledge here, and nobody is speaking down at anyone.

The name is literal

Somebody said we should open diplomatic relations with the raccoons.

Then a friend went out at 3am and actually talked to one.

That's the whole origin story. We kept the name because it's true, and because it's funny, and funny is free.

Why raccoons

Resourceful. Adaptable. They work with whatever's available and they show up for each other in the dark.

And they have no shame whatsoever. A raccoon caught in your bin makes eye contact. It is not sorry.

Shame is the thing that stops people asking for help. So there isn't any here.

What we actually think

We won't ask you to quit. Stopping is a good outcome. So is using less, using more safely, or swapping something for something gentler. Those all count. You pick.

Nobody gets a lecture. No scare stories, no "have you tried just stopping." If you want to talk about what you use, we're interested. If you don't, that's fine too.

No question is too basic. There are questions we're all glad someone finally asked.

We're raccoons, and we know how to call the people. We look after each other — that's most of what we do. But we're not a hospital and we've never pretended to be. Knowing when to call for help isn't a failure of the raccoon way. It *is* the raccoon way. Diplomacy means having someone to ring.

What we are right now

Small, and new. **About twelve of us in Kansas City.** We've met a few times, we have a Discord, and this page is most of our public presence.

We're the first Embassy — that's our word for a local group. There's one so far. We started with the local pagan community and we'd like to be useful to other alternative communities too.

We speak at Camp Gaea. We don't represent it, set its rules, or answer for it.

We'd like there to be more Embassies. That's a goal, not a description, and we'd rather tell you that than sound bigger than we are.

What we're not

Not a clinic, not a charity with a board, not medical or legal advice. For anything about doses or drug interactions we'll point you at **DanceSafe** (dancesafe.org) and **TripSit** (tripsit.me), who do that properly — rather than repeat their work with our name on it.

Want in? Come to the Discord. Lurk as long as you like.

We den together.

Safer Night Out

PACK

Test kit · naloxone · water · electrolytes · snacks · earplugs · charger

AGREE — BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Who your buddy is. Where you'll meet if phones die. When you'll check in.

DECIDE — NOW, NOT AT 2AM

Your ceiling. Your cut-off time. Tell someone both.

DON'T MIX, AND CHECK

Combining is where people get hurt. Check tripsit.me before you take anything together. Nothing + driving. Ever.

IF SOMEONE'S IN TROUBLE

Call 911. Stay with them. Tell the dispatcher what you know, then do what they say. Waiting to see if it gets better is what kills people.

NUMBERS WORTH HAVING

Poison Control 1-800-222-1222

Crisis / mental health 988

SAMHSA helpline 1-800-662-4357

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Consent Is a Living Conversation

ASK OUT LOUD — ANY TIME, ANY STAGE

"Do you want this?" · "Would you like me to stop?"

"Is this still good?" · "Can I touch you here?"

"Do you want company or space?"

NOT A YES

Silence · freezing · pulling away · confusion

Asleep · unconscious · too drunk to understand the ask

IT CAN CHANGE

The activity changes. The people change. New info appears. Someone just changes their mind. **Yes earlier is not yes now.** A relationship, a costume, a ride, a gift, a shared substance — none of that creates consent.

POWER IS IN THE ROOM

Driver / passenger · host / guest · sober / intoxicated · the person with housing · the organiser · the admired one.

Could they say no and still keep the ride, the bed, the group? If not, it isn't free.

IF YOU HEAR "STOP"

Direct · Distract · Delegate · Delay · Document.

Believe them. Ask what would help right now.

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